Forms in Flux

When narrative-led art uses metal to stage a collapse between human, animal and industrial mechanism

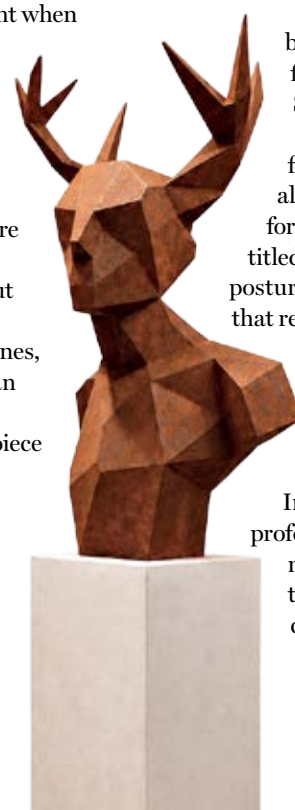
By **RIDHI KALE**

What do philanthropist Tina Ambani and venture capitalist Namita Thapar have in common? Among other things, it turns out they are both patrons of sculptor and designer Abhinav Goyal. With over 400 installations spanning public art, bespoke interiors and private collections, Goyal has proven his mastery over material precision. However, his latest solo series, *Post-Human Garden*, marks a distinct, deeply personal shift towards narrative-led metal art rooted in surrealism. "Post-Human Garden imagines life beyond fixed identities—forms that carry traces of the human, but are already evolving into something unfamiliar," shares Goyal. Working primarily with weathering steel (corten) and bronze, he uses metal not just as an industrial medium, but as a living skin that ages, weathers and actively records the passage of time.



The core premise of *Post-Human Garden* is a deliberate refusal to let a form remain just one thing. Across eleven sculptures, Goyal stages a slow collapse between tidy definitions: human and animal, organism and mechanism, ruin and growth. Rather than a static collection of objects, the series functions as an imagined habitat or a future relic landscape. "I'm interested in the moment when a form stops being one thing and begins becoming another—when the human, animal, organic and fabricated exist within the same body," he adds.

However, the highlight of the collection is the geometric language across the series that relies heavily on faceted planes to capture moments of intense emotional resonance, tension and stillness. In fact, several standout pieces anchor it, including Ram's Lament, a standing figure built from sharp, faceted planes, caught in a delicate balance between a human posture and the coiled horns of a ram. Then there is Tension of Becoming, a companion piece to Ram's Lament that arches forward with a bent spine, serving as a literal manifestation of transformation as an ongoing, unfinished bodily struggle. Biofabricant Nocturne is a faceted human torso crowned with grand, butterfly-like wings assembled like layered blades, a hybrid form that evokes a memory of flight after its industrial function is gone; while Spine Without Body stands as the tallest and most abstract piece in the series. This single, folding ribbon of steel leans against the wall, allowing raw architectural structure to stand in for physical anatomy. Another alluring piece is titled Feral Silence, a compact mass where human posture and rabbit anatomy merge, carrying a stillness that reflects instinct held in reserve. Completing the collection is Understory, a striking faceted bust that rises into a full rack of antlers, capturing the literal threshold where human limbs transition into branches.



Ultimately, *Post-Human Garden* offers Indian decor connoisseurs and art collectors a profound inquiry into contemporary life, presenting minimalist yet emotionally charged gestures that explore how life adapts and continues in completely unfamiliar forms.